

BackNine Product Audit — Keep / Freeze / Kill

August 2026 · reviewed with David 2026-08-25 (amendments marked ★) · against the spine: “My health, scored weekly, competed with my foursome.” Since first draft, Health Span Score went sensor-only (v2).

The core loop: open the app → see your Weekly Health Span Score and Bio Age → see where you stand in the league → do the Daily Check-in → get one good Coach AI line → log the minimum (sleep / meds / meal / workout). Every surface below is judged by one question: does it make that loop stronger, or is it a promise we keep for no one?

Definitions. **KEEP:** core loop — polish, maintain, all new work goes here. **FREEZE:** stays shipped, zero new investment, bug-fixed only if it breaks the core; hide where cheap. **KILL:** remove from the UI now (code stays dormant in the repo).

KEEP — the spine (9 surfaces)

Weekly Health Span Score	The scoreboard. The one number the app exists to move.
Biological Age (+ share card)	The outcome anchor and the viral artifact. Bevel counter.
Weekly League + leaderboards	The king. Social is the moat — see consolidation note below.
Daily Check-in	The daily habit anchor; feeds Coach AI and the streak.
Coach AI briefing + chat	The voice of the app. One coach, already consolidated.
Stack adherence (meds/supps)	Core to the 50+ audience; feeds Health Span. As-is, no expansion.
Data plumbing (Oura, HealthKit, Withings-via-AH, manual)	Nothing works without trusted data. Most bug-fix budget goes here.
This Week's Activity timeline	Read-only trust surface — “the app saw my Pilates class.” Cheap to keep.
Doctor Handoff one-pager + labs OCR	The quiet moat. No other consumer app walks into the exam room.

Plus the non-negotiable chassis: auth/SIWA, profile, onboarding, capability toggles. ★ Added at review: friend DMs, challenges, goals/goal coach, and the specialty report library — see amended freeze entries.

FREEZE — shipped, stop investing (the long tail)

Nutrition: keep basic meal logging + protein (feeds Health Span). Freeze the AI plate coach, nutrition extras, macro-preset depth, body-comp report.

Training: keep basic workout logging (feeds Health Span). Freeze PR badges, lifetime PRs, muscle heatmap, template browser, training load cards, prescribed Today's Workout, exercise history, injury flags.

★ **Social beyond the foursome (REVIEWED):** friend DMs and challenges STAY LIVE (trash talk needs a channel; challenges are a competition mechanic). Freeze Groups, group chat, group challenges, Pulse feed depth. Keep one-tap taunts/cheers.

★ **Coach adjacencies (REVIEWED):** goals/goal coach STAY LIVE (commitment device). Freeze Insights feed, Daily Insight card, correlations, coach memory card, and experiments (Proven For You — unfreeze when there's a user base to prove against).

★ **Doctor layer (REVIEWED):** the specialty REPORT LIBRARY STAYS LIVE alongside the Handoff one-pager (annual physical, cardiometabolic, training recovery, pre-procedure, goal progress). Freeze Visit Prep mode and visit modals only.

★ **Nutrition / Training / Rituals (REVIEWED — confirmed):** basic meal + workout logging stay; all other tab depth freezes. Weekly Recap freezes, Gear tab hides from nav, vices + hydration capability-gate, BP card stays

data-capture (now auto-fed by Withings via Apple Health).

CPAP stays exactly as-is: capability-gated, invisible unless switched on. This is the template for every niche feature from now on.

KILL — remove the corpses

Already dead in the UI, still in the repo: JournalCard, TonightSleepCard, WeeklyInsight, NudgeCard, TodaysTagsCard, StackEfficacyCard, ProvenLedgerCard, the old Longevity card. Delete the dead component files — today's stray `lib/page.tsx` bug is what unburied code costs.

Two consolidations the audit forces

1. Three leaderboard surfaces is one too many. Weekly League (Clubhouse), Today's Leaderboard (Scorecard), LeagueGlance (Scorecard) — we just spent a session making them agree with each other. That's the breadth tax in one anecdote. Recommendation: LeagueGlance + one full leaderboard; fold the daily matchup (steps/sleep/activity, head-to-head, taunts) into the Weekly League page as its top section.

2. The Metrics tab is a data admin panel, not a destination. Connection status, sync buttons, charts. Fine — but it should feel like Settings, not compete with the Scorecard. No investment beyond reliability.

What this buys

Every bug this week was a consistency failure across surfaces, not a hard problem: leaderboards disagreeing on methodology, a feature interaction slowing startup, a new user hitting two rough edges in her first session. Fewer live surfaces = fewer ways to disagree.

Launch test (the Julie test): a brand-new user's first session reaches the full core loop — score, league, check-in, one coach line, one log — with **zero rough edges**. We ship new features again when that test passes three new users in a row.

What this is NOT

Not deleting work. Frozen code stays; discovery wasn't waste — it's how we found the spine (sleep debt took 8 versions to learn the card should die; that lesson is now permanent). When the foursome loop is humming and retention proves it, we unfreeze deliberately, one surface at a time, behind capability toggles.